

LYMPH AND IMMUNE SYSTEMS

THE IMMUNE SYSTEM, INCORPORATING THE LYMPHATIC SYSTEM, IS THE MAIN MEANS BY WHICH THE BODY IS PROTECTED FROM INVASION BY MICROORGANISMS.

The lymphatic system contains lymph, a fluid that originates in the interstitial spaces between cells. Lymph drains into networks of tiny capillaries in tissue spaces that unite to form larger vessels called lymphatics. Nodes scattered along the length of the lymphatics filter and store the lymph. Organs, such as the thymus and spleen, and lymphoid tissue, such as tonsils and Peyer's patches, complete the system. They contain many specialized white blood cells, which protect the body against non-self material such as microorganisms.

